MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

BBA (HONOURS) THIRD SEMESTER EXAMINATION (2024ADMISSION ONWARDS)

MG3CCRBBA200 – Human Resource Management

Time: 2 Hours **Max Marks: 70**

Part A – Short Answer (four to five sentences)

(A Choice between two options for each question, answer one short answer question from each pair 1a/1b, 2a/2b, 3a/3b, 4a/4b, 5a/5b)

1a. What is Strategic Human Resource Management? Why is it important in a globally competitive environment? CO1(U)

OR

1b. List any three key functions of HRM and briefly explain anyone. CO1(U)

2a. Differentiate between Job Description and Job Specification with examples. CO2(U)

OR

2b. List the key stages of the employee life cycle in chronological order with suitable explanation for each. CO2 (U)

3a. You are asked to prepare a Job Description for a Sales Executive. Which two elements would you include and why? CO2(A)

OR

3b. Your organization prefers internal hiring. Apply two internal recruitment sources for a new managerial role. CO2(A)

4a. Differentiate between the 360-degree feedback method and the traditional ranking method in terms of fostering employee development. CO3 (An)

4b. Compare the Critical Incident Method and Behaviorally Anchored Rating Scales (BARS) in terms of how they evaluate employee behavior. CO3(An)

5a. What is a Human Resource Information System (HRIS)? Mention its two main components. CO4 (U)

OR

5b.Mention any three key characteristics of HRM in service-based organizations. CO4(U)

3*5=15

Part B- Short Essay
(A Choice between two options for each question, answer three short essay questions, one from each pair 6a/6b, 7a/7b, 8a/8b)

6a. From hiring to retirement, HRM plays a vital role in every employee's journey." Explain this statement in light of the scope of HRM. CO1 (U)

OR

6b. Explain the role of HRM in globally competitive environment. CO1 (U)

7a. Examine traditional and modern performance appraisal methods and analyze which would be more suitable for a startup company. CO3(An)

OR

7b. How can an organization use wage and salary administration to motivate its employees? CO3(An)

8a. Healthy employees tend to be more productive. Interpret it. CO4(A)

OR

8b. How would you apply HR analytics to forecast future hiring needs in an organization experiencing rapid growth? CO4(A)

3*5=15

Part C – Long Essay
(A Choice between two options for each question, answer short essay questions, one from each pair 9a/9b)

9a. You are appointed as the HR Manager of a newly established healthcare organization. Draft a human resource plan covering manpower forecasting, recruitment strategies, and measures to overcome possible challenges in the HR planning process. CO2(A)

9b. Prepare a comprehensive training and development strategy for a retail chain facing poor customer service ratings. Include objectives, methods, types of training, and expected outcomes. CO2(A)

1*20=20

Compulsory Case Study

10 a. Case Study 1: Unilever's Global Virtual Team for Sustainable Innovation CO2(An)
Background:
Unilever, a global FMCG giant, has committed to achieving sustainability goals by 2030. To drive this initiative, the company formed a virtual innovation team consisting of employees from its R&D, marketing, and supply chain departments across the UK, India, Brazil, and the Netherlands. The team was tasked with designing eco-friendly packaging solutions.

The team collaborated using platforms like Microsoft Teams, Trello, and cloud-based simulation tools. Members worked asynchronously due to time zone differences. Although the project progressed well, some issues emerged—cultural misunderstandings, uneven participation, and a lack of emotional connection among team members.

The Turning Point:
To address the issues, Unilever introduced structured "virtual bonding" sessions, digital brainstorming rooms, and a rotation system for team leads. With clear guidelines and regular feedback loops, the virtual team succeeded in developing a biodegradable packaging model within nine months—now implemented in over 30 countries.

1. Describe the characteristics of the virtual workforce highlighted in the Unilever
2. Define the concept of a virtual employee and explain how it applies in this case.
3. Analyse the impact of cross-cultural communication on the team's performance

1*20=20